

A Brilliant \$3,000,000/Month Shopify Supplement Brand

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Jul 22, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iS7S5N6fn9w> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Arie Scherson breaks down Ultra Pouches, a supplement-in-a-pouch brand that reached \$24M annual revenue run rate in 6 months, highlighting their ad hook strategy, subscription model, landing page, and multi-market targeting.

Contents

- 🌱 The Nicotine Pouch Market Opportunity
- 🚀 Ultra Pouches: Brand Overview & Growth
- 🎯 The "Free" Ad Hook Dissected
- 📦 Subscription Model & Landing Page Breakdown
- 🛒 Checkout Flow & Shopify Plus
- 📈 Multi-Market Expansion & Ad Variety
- 💡 Key Takeaways on Business Models

The Nicotine Pouch Market Opportunity 0:00

- The nicotine pouches market is one of the fastest-growing e-commerce markets
 - Current market size estimated at **\$6.9B–\$8.6B**
 - Expected to grow to **\$24B–\$42B over the next decade**
- The *faster*-growing market is actually the alternative-to-nicotine-pouch space
 - Brands are taking the pouch form factor and filling it with entirely different products (e.g., supplements)
 - The pouch form factor itself is the innovation being leveraged

Ultra Pouches: Brand Overview & Growth 0:44

- Ultra Pouches went from **zero to \$24M revenue run rate in 6 months** from launch
 - This is not a typical bootstrapped e-com brand — they raised significant capital
 - Raised **\$11M in a Series A**
 - NFL quarterback **Joe Burrow** is an investor
- Arie discovered the brand via **Get Hooked** (ad intelligence tool)

- His filter settings: top ads only, US market
- What stands out most: **extraordinarily consistent traffic**
 - Roughly **500,000 monthly visitors, month over month**, with almost no variation
 - Described as "boom, boom, boom" — no spikes or drops
 - This consistency is especially powerful when combined with a subscription model

🎯 The "Free" Ad Hook Dissected 1:57

- A specific ad caught Arie's attention for its clever use of the word "free"
- The ad script, verbatim:
 - "Free Ultras. We're giving away Ultras for free."
 - "Free of nicotine. Free of caffeine. Free of crash. Free of jitters."
 - "Free of stimulants that jack your heart rate and wreck your sleep."
 - "It doesn't constrict your blood vessels and it doesn't spike your nervous system."
 - "No more wired than fried cycle."
 - "Most focus products trap you. Ultra does the opposite."
 - "Free your blood flow, free your focus, and feel free. Take Ultra."
- The ad does NOT actually give anything away for free
 - "Free" refers to being *free from* the negative side effects of competing products
 - The landing page shows a standard paid offer (no free product)
- Why this hook works:
 - The word "free" is psychologically powerful and instantly grabs attention
 - Arie references using free-plus-shipping offers back in 2018 when he first hit \$100K/month dropshipping — the word still works
 - It's a **product-aware ad**: targets people who already know about pouches and their downsides
- Trade-off of this approach:
 - Will NOT scale to cold, mass audiences easily
 - Will deliver **high ROAS and better CPA** from warm/aware audiences

The word "free" is weaponized not as a discount, but as a positioning statement — freeing the customer from everything they hate about competitor products.

📦 Subscription Model & Landing Page Breakdown 3:41

- Ultra runs on a **subscription-first business model**
 - Re-bill price example: **\$31 when you order 3** on subscription
 - Creates predictability, durability, and recurring revenue

- The landing page uses urgency tactics:
 - "Next batch ships in 1 day. Reserve your Ultras before we sell out again."
 - Suggests they ship in batches — adds scarcity framing
- A quantity-selector widget incentivizes larger orders:
 - Unlocks **free shipping at \$52** — visible, gamified threshold
- Running **620 active ads simultaneously**
 - Common among top-performing brands, especially those with funding
 - Subscription brands benefit most from heavy ad volume because LTV justifies higher CAC
- Arie's personal note: he now runs his own subscription brand for the same reasons — predictability and always being present in the customer's life

Checkout Flow & Shopify Plus 4:09

- Ultra skips the cart entirely — clicking buy goes **straight to checkout**
 - Reduces friction and drop-off in the purchase flow
- They use **Shopify Plus**, which allows full checkout customization
- Arie's recommendation on Shopify Plus:
 - Threshold to consider: **\$200K/month or more in revenue**
 - Benefits:
 - Lower processing fees (can offset the plan cost)
 - Phone support — faster, higher-quality help
 - More stability when scaling fast (payments less likely to be frozen)
 - Current promotional offer mentioned: **\$500/month for 2 months**
 - At scale, processing fee savings alone can make this cash-flow positive
- Also recommends **Disputify** for chargeback fraud protection
 - Chargeback fraud is common in the US e-com market
 - Arie uses it on his own brand

Multi-Market Expansion & Ad Variety 8:20

- Ultra leverages their **blood flow angle** to enter the **erectile dysfunction (ED) market**
 - ED is described as a "massive market"
 - The same product benefit (improved blood flow) maps onto a completely different audience
 - This is a key growth lever: one product, multiple problem-aware markets
- They also run **whitelisted ads** from influencers/recognizable figures
 - Example: a 9-second clip of someone saying "You start taking lip pillows at the gym"
 - "Lip pillow" is slang used by younger demographics for pouch products

- Ad strategy summary: Ultra is doing "everything right"
 - High-volume creative testing (620 ads)
 - Hook-driven cold traffic ads
 - Influencer/whitelist ads
 - Multi-market angle expansion
 - Subscription model for retention



Key Takeaways on Business Models 2:50

- Arie's broader philosophy: **having a better business model is itself a growth hack**
 - You can make money with one-off dropshipping products, but those businesses rarely survive long-term
 - His past one-product dropshipping stores "are no longer alive" — that's the point
- Subscriptions aren't the only path, but they are one of the best:
 - Other valid long-term strategies: product expansion, market expansion
 - Subscriptions specifically provide: predictability, durability, and ongoing customer relationships
- The core innovation of Ultra Pouches:
 - **Switching form factors** — putting supplements into a pouch format
 - Borrowing the delivery mechanism from nicotine pouches and applying it to a cleaner product
 - Using "free" language as a hook to reframe product benefits vs. competitors
- Actionable steps implied by the breakdown:
 - Look for fast-growing form factors in adjacent markets and apply them to new product categories
 - Use product-aware ad hooks (like the "free from X" framing) for high-intent audiences
 - Build toward subscription revenue for long-term business stability
 - Consider Shopify Plus at \$200K+/month for fee savings and support
 - Use tools like Get Hooked to find and reverse-engineer top-performing ads